

Modern people tend to spend time alone with technology, especially emerging technologies like AI robots and smartphones. Individualism is a social phenomenon that is rapidly spreading around the world, and the number is on an increase. A report says that in the US, 28 per cent of all households have people living alone. These people believe that there is no need for another human being or companion. In the novel *Robinson Crusoe*, Robinson Crusoe decides to leave the island in the end. Do you think if an AI robot or smartphone was there with him, he would have returned to England at all?

Job displacement

There is a fear that AI and robotic process automation (RPA) will displace tens of millions of jobs in the US. That is, work as we know it today will not exist for many people, including retail stores, truck drivers and others. Technology will continue to advance, taking over even more jobs.

There have been similar fears with other technologies as well. Advent of the personal computer (PC) in the 1980s led to widespread fear that computers would lead to mass unemployment. On the contrary, computers created more jobs.

Take the classic case of an automated teller machine (ATM). While human bank tellers per bank have decreased, ATMs have helped reduce the cost of opening new bank offices in general, so the number of bank offices have increased, which, in turn, has resulted in hiring more bank-related workers and therefore more bank tellers. However, job description of bank tellers has changed—it focuses more on handling customer relations from previous routine tasks that are now automated.

Same is the case with predictions based on AI. Many experts feel that there is nothing to fear. It is because the number of jobs created by AI and automation in general will likely outnumber the jobs displaced. The only doubt is whether the displaced workers will have the capabilities to do these new jobs.

AI surveillance

New technologies can improve our lives, but such technologies as AI

surveillance come with many privacy concerns. For example, AI surveillance systems are installed everywhere in China. These AI-based face-recognition systems are used by the government to supervise the lives of its citizens. AI algorithms decide certain benefits in society as per social credit scores. For example, citizens having high credit scores do not need to pay deposits at hotels and can easily obtain visas to travel abroad. Meanwhile, those with low credit scores cannot easily eat in restaurants, register at hotels, purchase products or travel freely.

Technological singularity

As per Wikipedia, technological singularity (or singularity) is a hypothetical point in the future when technological growth becomes uncontrollable and irreversible, resulting in unfathomable changes to human civilisation. It is related to intelligence explosion, an upgradable intelligent agent such as a robot with artificial general intelligence that would enter self-improvement cycles, continue to upgrade itself and advance technologically at an incomprehensible rate, resulting in a powerful super intelligence surpassing all human intelligence.

Some experts say that there is a possibility to achieve singularity within this century, while others say that singularity is a matter of belief, not science. However, it no longer seems beyond the realm of possibility. As of now, the subject is quite divisive, and consequences of singularity and its potential benefits or harms to the human race are being intensely debated.

Conclusion

It is true that AI has achieved some amazing feats including beating humans at various games, self-driving cars, cancer detection in humans and others, but the reality is that AI still has a long way to go. AI robots are nowhere near achieving the level of human intelligence, but a lot of progress has been made with limited AI algorithms during recent years.

While some news on AI is true, many are just hype. As such, there is nothing to fear, just brace yourself and welcome the new and emerging technologies, and try to make use of AI in the most beneficial way. **EFY**



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